Copyright Statement

The Fillius Jazz Archive at Hamilton College has made a reasonable effort to secure permission from the interviewees to make these materials available to the public. Use of these materials by other parties is subject to the fair use doctrine in United States copyright law (Title 17, Chapter 1, Paragraph 107) which allows use for commentary, criticism, news reporting, research, teaching or scholarship without requiring permission from the rights holder.

Any use that does not fall within fair use must be cleared with the rights holder. For assistance in contacting the rights holder please contact the Fillius Jazz Archive, Hamilton College, 198 College Hill Road, Clinton, NY 13323.

Sherrie Maricle Part II
(The Covid Interview)

The Covid-19 pandemic impacted the music and arts community particularly hard. Musicians who had previously been interviewed for the Fillius Jazz Archive graciously shared their experiences during this virtual shutdown period. The political and racial unrest occurring simultaneously was also addressed.

Sherrie was interviewed via Zoom on June 4, 2020, by Monk Rowe, Director of the Fillius Jazz Archive.

MR: My name is Monk Rowe for the Fillius Jazz Archive. I'm pleased to have Sherrie Maricle with me remotely from Pennsylvania. Correct?

SM: Right. Westchester, Pennsylvania.

MR: Okay. So we had a brief chat before we started about the joy of drum lessons online.

SM: Well you know some people are so successful at it if you are very tech savvy and audio conscious beyond the acoustic, which I am not. So it's presenting quite a bit of challenge teaching at the University of the Arts and finishing up drum lessons and drumset juries all through Zoom, which we're very grateful for Zoom but it did present some — I mean great opportunity but just like I said, everybody's got different audio tech skills so it was an effort.

MR: Yeah. I had a similar experience with doing the saxophone lessons and you see them playing, as soon as they start playing like the sound cuts out.

SM: Oh that too of course, yeah. I wasn't even getting to the Internet connection issues sometimes, but just the sound of the drums, especially if you're just using your phone or your computer, of course the drums immediately overpower the microphone and makes it all sound like static.

MR: Did your university change grading?

SM: Yes. And I'm just teaching just applied lessons, on juries were all pass/fail.

MR: Yeah. Was it, I'm plugging in my headphones, hold on.

SM: Okay.

MR: Was it a controversial discussion?

SM: Well I'm sure the classroom teachers had more of a conversation than the applied teachers I spoke with. We figured — I mean it would be very rare for a jazz drumset major to fail their drum lessons, so it wasn't that controversial for us. But I don't know, probably more how it affects the students' GPA in a negative way because you know, it

just didn't allow us to give them their, more likely A, on their lessons. So that was how it impacted us.

MR: I think it's a scary thought amongst many scary thoughts about actually starting the semester with online lessons. It's one thing to finish out five or six weeks, but to actually just start it, I mean people do it, some people do it as a matter, a regular system. But I'm not looking forward to that myself.

SM: No. And is Hamilton definitely going to be virtual?

MR: They actually, the last thing I heard was hopeful but that could change.

SM: Yeah. I mean I guess, and I'm not sure about the University of the Arts, but I think if we were allowed back on campus it's surely easy enough to keep six feet away during a drum lesson and wear a mask.

MR: You might like it, being six feet away.

SM: Yeah. With earplugs. Only kidding. But yeah, well this is just complete Twilight Zone time for all of us. Very crazy. And you know I will share, well today actually the DIVA Jazz Orchestra was scheduled to be in San Paolo, Brazil with Nneena Freelon, so we have had — one of the many festivals that were cancelled with all of my groups. So it's painful and surreal to see all of those opportunities leave, and then, and with no end in sight for when we possibly will recoup even the smallest bit of live performance. It's very strange.

MR: Were any of the people that cancelled, did they try to do their best to say well we're going to reschedule?

SM: Yeah, in some cases I pursued it right away, like for example in March we were scheduled, usually DIVA does four nights at Dizzy's Club in New York City, at Jazz at Lincoln Center every March, it's our birthday and we've been playing there since the club opened. So we were scheduled in March to do a brand new live recording, "DIVA Swings Broadway" and it was cancelled, and I didn't even fiddle around with trying to say well we'll come in the fall. I just said please just put us down for next March, so we have our March 11 to the 14th everybody, 2021, DIVA Jazz. But the point of that is that any performing arts centers and even jazz clubs book at least a year in advance. So the majority of people booked through the end of this year and well into 2021. So it'll be very hard to recoup everything. Another example, the Gilmore Keyboard Festival, which is a major piano festival in Kalamazoo Michigan, the trio was scheduled there. And that's a massive multi-week event. It was cancelled, and hopefully we'll be able to reschedule for 2021. Every opportunity is different. I know that the Berks Jazz Festival here in PA, the festival director John Onester just wrote to everybody and said, "Okay, everybody that was for 2020 we're just going to do the same thing but in 2021. And that's again, like dozens and dozens and dozens of acts over multiple days. So everyone is handling it

MR: Yeah. We're hoping that those venues and festivals can still exist in 2021.

SM: I know, Monk, that's such a great point, and you know recently, well last week reading things about great iconic clubs in New York like Small's that are really — major performance clubs, of course the Blue Note, the Vanguard, Dizzy's, and Jazz Standard and those places, I'm assuming have enough, are financially secure to survive this. But other iconic clubs that are really like the heart and soul that give so many artists an opportunity like Small's and Mezzro and Fat Cat and they're like you said, I don't know if the New York landlords are being nice and letting them get a break on their rent. I don't know. I hope so. I don't know what's going to happen.

MR: I had a question that I've tried to hone down but I haven't really done it yet, but are there things that you do now, or let's say up until March, over the years, that took a lot of time and energy and assuming that at some point we get back to normal, you would think twice about actually doing them again because you've noticed that your life is easier because you're not?

SM: Well man, that's a great question. What I do spend a lot of my time as the sole booker of the DIVA jazz orchestra and my quintet, Five Play. And I'm a co-leader with a new trio called the 3-D Jazz Trio. So I spend ages and endless amounts of hours and weeks and months and years trying to book those groups. Aggressively. I mean that was part of my day job you know, as a band leader without a booking agency. So in the end sometimes I'd be easily eight hours a day, especially booking a tour, even working on a two week tour, and doing all of it mostly myself. I don't know — and I haven't done it, except other than we mentioned before trying to re-book some things that were lost, I haven't been as aggressive to look for dates in support of other dates, and I don't know if I'll necessarily go back to that to such an extreme degree. I was very aggressive about it. And it was successful in many cases but that was a lot of hours in the day where I wasn't really thinking about music, and that was the kind of activity that makes me not like music, or the music business. Like all the things that don't have to do with playing your instrument and trying to create something beautiful with other musicians, it can be really frustrating to all of us, every freelance performer, you know, if you're running your own band or business or whatever it's just man, all the things that don't have to do directly with your thing and the creative process can be so taxing and really time consuming and really frustrating. So I'm not saying I'm not going to do it but I'm thinking like I have practiced more, I was practicing one day and I was out just sitting at my drums for well over five hours. Now I haven't done that at all since college. And I couldn't believe how fast the time flew by. And everyone talks about, not everyone, but some people talk about being in the flow state where you're just doing that thing that you love so much. And I'm

things out. And I'm like man, and I'm getting these little goose bumps sometimes when I'm very enthusiastic about something. And that for me was like oh my God this is so great. Like I actually love the drums again. I love the drums so much. Because when you're the band leader sometimes there's just so much other stuff going on I, anyway, forget like I love playing the drums and this is what I've done since I was eleven years old. So not being distracted by, "Oh no, we don't have another gig." "Oh no, we're going to lose money if we get this bus." Or, "Oh gosh, how much is the airline overcharge to move the music stands" and blah blah blah blah blah. You know. And I'm very lucky to have the help of Jami Dauber who's been acting as our band manager and road manager for quite a while. She's played trumpet in the band like 23 years. And, but jeez, all that stuff being gone, to further answer your question it's just like oh, here I am back to kind of the core, you know the center of where my musical journey started, and it reminded me that I really do love it in that way.

MR: Well that's one upside. I'm curious what does a drumset player practice for five hours?

SM: Oh my gosh, well I spend a lot of time working on different, and this is recently, just different technical things and technical approaches. Like there's a lot more than one way to hit a drum, this way, there's using your fingers, there's using every finger, there's stick placement, there's wrist movement, there's certain bounce techniques and with both hands and both feet I just, stuff like that, I'm like wow. Like for example on thing I practice quite a bit it's called a push/pull technique and a lot of Brazilian players use it to play eighth notes when they're playing samba. And it can be like a lot of American drummers are trained to use their wrist, cha-cha-cha-cha-cha, you know, or fingers this way. Brazilian players go cha-cha/cha-cha. It's like a drop and catch. So when you get that technique going, and I haven't mastered it but I can do it, you can go [scats] like really fast eighth notes with this really interesting feel. So stuff like that, like in the normal course of booking gigs and working gigs like you try to sneak in those things but to really have time to sit around and practice it — and then maybe like oh, let me check out wow, all these things of Max Roach or Elvin Jones or Philly Joe Jones or any drummer that you just keep finding new things and new videos and new lessons. And it's great. It's really great.

MR: Well not only that I think you just gave a brief lesson to like wind players — that was some pretty cool double tonguing you just did [scats].

SM: Yeah. [Scats] It's good to sing drum fills that way.

MR: Yeah. Okay. Most people are of course connected to their jobs, it's a huge part of their life. But I think artists and musicians etcetera often times define themselves from what they do. And I'm wondering if you're feeling sort of a loss of identity with this current

SM: Oh yeah. I mean a lot, you know in my own journey aside from music just in basic mental and self help genres which I am a great consumer of, I love something that Wayne Dyer, a great guru who I love all of his work, he always said, "Well listen, you're a human being not a human doing because if you stop doing you don't stop being." And I loved that. So I think about that all the time and I'm like who am I now that I'm not — I mean we're all a lot of things. But the way that you function in the world or serve the world and your community and just the thing that you want to give and share, when that's stopped — I mean we all know music hasn't stopped but the way that performers share it is together. And when I Zoom with my bandmates or my trio especially, we have a new CD out, we did a virtual Zoom release and streamed it live to FaceBook and played some music and talked. But almost — when we first started talking it almost put us into tears because we can't play together anymore. Even with the best technology, there's something called JamKazam where you can sort of play together but not really. It's just weird. Just being able to share music with each other and create music with each other is something, and for people, the audience and the listener, it's a huge component of it too. And we're entertainers as well.

MR: Exactly.

SM: It's a lot of things. So all of us have been asking the question well if you're not — am I still going to be a musician. I mean even if it's a rhetorical question, like if I'm not Sherrie the bandleader/drummer then who am I? I'm like Crazy Cat Lady? I don't know.

MR: It's almost like — I don't want those technologies to work.

SM: Yeah. I know what you mean. And I'm not leaping to embrace it. Some of my friends are like, "You've got to get this going because we're going to do X, Y and Z." And I'm like I don't really want to. I mean I guess if I had to, if there was no other way in the world — like for example I'm going to, and my bandmates are really good at using the app called Acappella. It works extremely well I guess with Apple products but not so much with Windows at the moment. But we're going to do a DIVA Jazz virtual recording. You know you each record your own track separately with a click track and then you layer it on, so we're going to do a little teaser from the CD we were going to do live at Dizzy's, we decided, a couple of my bandmates are good at that stuff so we're just going to record and put it out there. I don't want to, but I feel — I mean artistically I don't but for morale purposes and our friends and fans will enjoy it. So I'm going to go for it.

MR: Why don't you do one where you program the click track to speed up and slow down, just for the heck of it.

SM: That would be funny. Like humans do.

MR: Yes.

SM: Well that's the thing that is weird about it, and I've done layered recordings before and certainly — well I mean I practice with a metronome all the time. But you know, and I say this to students too, nobody has the desire, like I'm going to rush and drag. But when humans do anything together there's definitely moments where it's going — it doesn't matter if it's in music it's in general conversation, it's when you're having a business meeting, you know there's moments when the energy is like aagh and there's moments when it's like whew. And the music it's reflected sometimes with slight tempo variations. It's not the end of the world. I tell the students. If the metronome goes a few clicks on you, that's — you're a human being. That's what happens. We're excited and we're laying back. It's just, I don't know, every time you hear a recording that's done with the click track where a big band especially layers it, it does have a — it does seem inhuman and very sterile. Yeah.

MR: Yeah. It ain't Count Basie.

SM: No. And a lot of recordings, and we all have listened to them, if you want to be picky about it you can listen to the opening tempo and the ending tempo. It could be different. It still doesn't make you love it less.

MR: Well speaking of the end of the world —

SM: Oh yay.

MR: Yah. Do you have a personal thought about why this pandemic is happening now?

SM: That's a really fascinating question. Sure. I think I saw a funny meme and it's serious because I think there could be a true component to this. I don't know how the whole universe works, but it said, "This is the universe telling humans to go back to your room and think about what you've done." I mean that is really, I mean very broad, whatever everybody's philosophical, religious, or the origins of humanity views are I think if anything makes sense humans have been and are the most destructive force on this planet. And we are, we function collectively like, you know this is harsh wording but almost like a virus or a cancer, like we destroy everything in our path to serve ourselves with little regard for anything else. I know this is so general. But human beings as a species and how we interact with our ecosystem and the world, every other living being seems more or less to work in harmony without killing everything around it. So I don't know if this is true but I have had those thoughts. And then of course other thoughts about like what is the government doing? Is it something that we don't know about, which it also could be any of those things from bio warfare to like some other weird experiment? I don't know. And now, what's going on now, some people are convinced it's a hoax and are running around like nothing happened. I don't know.

MR: It's self-destructive, yeah. Speaking of the government do you have — how do you feel

SM: I think the federal government's — I mean I am not a Trump supporter in any way, particularly of the Mitch McConnell and all the Senate starting way back from Paul Ryan and Lindsay Graham. I think — I can't figure out if they — if this is part of a — if the GOP has become a cult or if they all have the same form of mental illness. I mean I really don't know. I don't understand what their motives are for some of this behavior, or supporting a president who is clearly a sociopathic narcissist and has severe mental illness, who can't even speak in sentences, coherent sentences. I don't understand it. It's really scary. And I thought the whole response and reaction, and lack of response and barely a reaction from the pandemic was just outrageous and unforgivable with no federal plan or a guideline, or even the simplest — the simplest thing you want from a leader is for somebody to stand in front of you and try to make everything better, or give you focus and hope that we're going to get through this and this is going to be great. We've got none of that on that level. And I think all the governors are of course doing their best, but you know I heard a couple of months ago the governor of North Carolina I believe said, "Oh I didn't know this was contagious" or something so insane. So not having any guidance from the top and relying on all of our governors, who are also great leaders, it's been mixed messages all across the board from the leadership. Pennsylvania I think is strict, because it's so close to New York City. I think tomorrow Pennsylvania is due to go into the Yellow Phase of its reopening but surely everybody will still be wearing a mask. Which I don't have any problem with. I mean I always thought to myself anytime I got to travel to any Asian country how great and respectful that was that that culture wears a mask if they're sick because they don't want to get anybody else sick. And that's been going on forever. And then for people to be offended and, "You're taking away my freedom," it's like the same thing as no shirt, no shoes, no service. No, wear a mask or get out. Because it's not about you, it's about everybody else too. It's not just about you. So in Philadelphia now, and I'm sure you're going to go to this topic, is having major riots every night and has an 8:00 curfew. And I live about 25 miles west of Philadelphia. I just moved out of Philadelphia in March. And the city is in chaos right now. And all the major bridges, and like in New York too, in and out of the city, have been closed because of riots. So I don't know what's going to happen if we're going to re-open on Friday or not, combined with all the looting. In Center City Philadelphia one of the major areas by the big Kimmel Performing Arts Center, that's like the Carnegie Hall of Philly, like from Chase Bank to all the stores and retailers, restaurants, all the windows are smashed out. There's been crazy looting.

MR: Historians are going to have a field day with 2020.

SM: I know. I can't even imagine what anyone looking back on this is going to think. Like

course I'm going to — with the leadership and the government and why Donald Trump even got elected. I mean I was just Zooming with my friend in England before our talk. And they think the United States has gone berserk, like crazy, like how did you elect a person like that. And I think it's because some people in my family, who will remain nameless, "Oh well we just wanted something different." And I said, "But, what?" I mean I get that but that you would vote for a thing like Donald Trump who clearly has no empathy, no intellect, no experience, no understanding. It's just so insane that people are brainwashed by reality TV or his TV show. I don't know what it is.

MR: I don't either, and I've run out of adjectives. If you need some adjectives about him, read George Will's latest thing for the *Washington Post*. He came up with some good ones. Good — you know bad good ones.

SM: Yeah. What was that one that's a — was it like a cockwambler or something? It was one funny real long word that was like a blustering fool who doesn't know anything, some word that was like oh there's Trump again. You've got to take out some old Victorian words or something. But I will, I'll check that out.

MR: Have you taken up any non-musical initiatives to fill time?

SM: Well yeah, I mean this year, in past year's I've done this too but in recent years have not had time, so I planted a big herb garden and that kind of thing is fun, and did a little more landscaping, especially this new house I have, it's a converted dairy barn from the 1800s in Westchester. It's very cool. It's not on a lot of acres or anything, it's about two acres. But it's very, very pretty. And I'm going to backtrack for a second because I moved March 25th and I was like, "Okay, it's a pandemic, all the gigs are gone, but I'm moving to this new house with my partner, Susan," and I'm going to do this, I'm going to go back to running. I mean I was a marathon runner, I had all these plans. And I broke my foot in three places, my left foot. The day I was moving I fell off one step, my left foot twisted, and the three bones right in the middle of my foot, I heard them. So I couldn't walk for six weeks, to add fun to my experience. But now, as of Monday I'm able to walk around in my normal shoe. But I was six weeks without walking, then I was another five weeks, yeah about a month in an orthopedic boot. A big one. And it still hurts. But I was still playing the whole time. I was doing music videos and instructional stuff, a lot of brushes. But my hi-hat foot was out of commission.

MR: I was going to ask which foot it was, and I can picture your appointment. "So Doc, when can I start playing the hi-hat."

SM: That is what I said and I demonstrated to him how I play, I pound very hard on my toe. I play with my heel off the ground. And so he said that I have something called a "dancer's break." He said it's a perfect combination of when your foot twists and all your weight

started doing, because Monday I said I got the okay you don't have to wear the boot anymore, put on your shoe, and various exercises. So, anyone can stand on one foot, that's no problem. But when your foot has not been walked on in two months, I was trying to just stand on my left foot and you know how there's so many muscles and tendons and nerves and bones in your food and none of them have been active. So I mean I can do it for a number of seconds but it's really amazing. Now it's going to take a while for my left foot to get back to it's pounding hi-hat greatness.

MR: Well I didn't expect that answer when I asked you if you've been doing anything non-musical.

SM: Well I love to cook. I cook like a jazz musician, I improvise everything. I watch the Food Network a lot. So I'm always trying to make things I see on the Food Network. So I love doing that. And I have been doing a lot of that.

MR: Good.

SM: And thinking about plans for this barn. My place in Philadelphia I had lived in an old stationary factory and we turned the first floor into a performing arts space called Drummers. So this barn, while it's still in relative, it's in some chaos, because like I said I'm just getting back on my feet, but this is going to be a performing arts space too. So it's a whole downstairs area, it was a dairy barn, old stables and stuff and a huge garage and these super cool area in the back that could be a great recording studio or like a colonial pub. And there's this. I'm actually, I don't know how well you can see this,

MR: Wow.

SM: That structure in the back is, I call it the tin can. That's about a 2200 square foot house that we live in. Here's the upstairs where there can be a balcony or a second floor. And then you can't really see the whole thing but anyway, it's a big barn.

MR: Wow. Thanks for the tour.

SM: Well so that's going to be a performing space too, and as soon as we're allowed to gather I'm going to have a concert here, at least with my trio, because we're set up to roll with that and invite the whole neighborhood, just for fun.

MR: Well let someone else move the piano, all right?

SM: Yeah. You know when you think about how stupid to fall off of one step. I mean it's so stupid I can't even believe it when I think back. It' so annoying. My right foot got twisted in a blanket, and then of course I'm thinking oh good, there's a pandemic, everything is closed. So I drove myself to, like I said, it was the day we were moving so the moving trucks were there so Susan couldn't come with me so I drove myself to Urgent Care which was a brand new one on Girard Street in Philly, and nobody was there and they let me right in and then miraculously this orthopedic place was open. I was very happy I

MR: Yeah. Has Susan's job or employment or whatever she does, how has it been affected?

SM: Yes. Susan is the CEO of the Ronald McDonald House in Philadelphia, and she is on call 24 hours a day. For numerous reasons it's — if people don't know the Ronald McDonald House started in Philadelphia and it's the organization that houses critically ill children and their families while they're seeking medical treatment, from all over the world, particularly, I mean there's about 350 houses I believe around the world, and Susan's one of the primary houses, it serves families and children from all over the world. I mean they do things, amazing things for families, and it gives these people a safe place to stay with their critically ill children. And so when the pandemic hit and that ceased basically travel from everywhere that created challenges and issues for people that really needed to have their child, the child could only get — and a lot of times it's experimental treatment, and some people come, like in very critical situations, but getting the families here and then — they're healthy beyond the sick child, and then just finding, maintaining, making sure your staff is healthy to continue to serve them. I mean it's like running a 200-room facility for critically ill children. Like a hotel. And then with the riots happening in the city then that's created another — with a reduced staff for safety purposes, and now worrying about security with people. So she's like if I tell you somebody that, I mean she goes in and out of Philadelphia still quite a bit and she's there all day today in fact, but somebody that wakes up at like 4:30 in the morning and will work for hours and hours before she even goes to work. She's such a great human. She started out, she worked for the government in PA and she started out as a volunteer at the Ronald McDonald House. And she said in hindsight what she thought about the best part of her week and it always was being a volunteer at the Ronald McDonald House. So she went to talk to the then-CEO, whose name I can't remember, about just potentially like getting some advice about working in non-profit. And then Susan said before she left the office she had a job. And then she — her physician and her love of the organization and know-how just elevated her to her position. And she's great at it. Thanks for asking.

MR: Well I, you've also answered sort of my last question and that is during these last couple of months have you observed positive and negative aspects of people, and I appreciate that positive description that you just offered.

SM: Yeah. Well you see, like I'm amazed by my friends and bandmates and other friends and some are like so, so positive. Like within one day, like my last job was March 10. I was in Cedar Rapids, Iowa at Coe College. I was on a little solo tour, like I was in Nebraska at the Nebraska Band Master's Association. And I spent four days in Iowa and I went from, actually my trio was in Florida with Maurice Hines just before that. It was going great. I get home and then all you see, all your gigs like cancel, and it's horrifying and surreal.

lessons, here's my concert series." It's like wow. Like they're not letting anything — they're just so — and I'm sure like age is probably irrelevant but I've seen this from my younger bandmates especially. One is still in their twenties, they're like, "This isn't stopping me. Here's my concert series." Now they're lucky if they live with like if you're a bass player that lives with a pianist you're cool, or any horn player that lives with a piano player or bass player. But if you're a drummer and you live by yourself it's hard for me to make interesting solo concerts I think, for the general consumer. But yeah. And I'm involved with a great camp called Maryland Summer Jazz. That's an adult camp. Oh my gosh and I'm not kidding you when I tell you there's like physicists, an ex-Navy seal, like really smart and great, super intelligent adults that love jazz, so I always enjoy teaching there. So that's going to go virtual this year. It's in July. But interestingly because of the virtual nature now, the camp director, a guy named Jeff Antoniuk, now he's got Peter Erskine I think, Bob Mintzer, I don't know he's got all these like stars chiming in for a session because he doesn't have to fly them anywhere. Since the whole thing is virtual it's kind of opened up some, I guess, some opportunity for that. And that's a good thing.

MR: Yeah. I'm actually negotiating with a fellow in France who admires our project here and he says would you let me try to do some interviews with French musicians, and he'll send them to me, etcetera. So there are things that are happening that may not have happened.

SM: Hey, Monk, there's a — I did a tour with a great pianist named Oliver Jones, and the bass player on the gig was a French man named Pierre Boussaguet. I think he lives in Toulouse. And he did a duo record with Ray Brown and he's very much in the style of Ray. He's a great musician. He would be — if you're looking for any Frenchmen, he swings his brains out. He's great.

MR: Great. I may ask you to spell that name out for me.

SM: Okay. Sure.

MR: Before we close I wanted to just say again, you know you were at Hamilton, I'm not good with how long ago, maybe two years ago, and that was such a terrific concert musically but also the fact that when the concert was done all these junior high kids, like, "Oh, could we go on the stage?" And indeed, I mean I just got such a kick out of that, interacting with you and you were so kind to them. And I know they won't forget that.

SM: Yeah. Well I hope so. I mean you don't think about it when you're in the moment but when I think back to you know when I was eleven and got to go on Buddy Rich's bus to say hi, like to me it's like it was yesterday or when I shook Woody Herman's hand and met Mel Lewis, and saw Count Basie in his wheelchair outside Carnegie Hall last time I saw them play. Just, "Hi Mr. Basie." And he's like, "Hi," you know. Any of those interactions to me with people that I love so. Obviously I'm not elevating myself to any

standards like the people I just mentioned but just that somebody enjoyed the concert and wanted to talk to us. It makes a difference.

MR: Yeah. Well it's been a pleasure talking to you. And you said in our interview before, "You must exude a positive attitude on stage." I wrote that down. And you still are.

SM: Thank you, Monk. I'm really happy to be here, thank you for asking me. This was like a highlight since March 10, this has been one of the best things I've done.

MR: Well me too. I appreciate it. I'll check my calendar but I think March 10 was my last gig too. Yeah.

SM: Yeah. Well I still have, my trio still has one on the books at the Deer Head Inn for August 15 so I'm not sure if it's going to happen. I know the Deer Head keeps hanging on, too. That's in the Delaware Water Gap in Pennsylvania. And hopefully.

MR: You know it begs the question, just to wrap up, if they put that on you, if they called and said we'll do the gig if you want to, and things are still like not totally back to normal, you're going to have a decision to make, right?

SM: Yeah. I mean the trio on the stage, for us we would definitely be six feet apart as performers. But for the Deer Head it would have to make sense if they could open with social distancing, and I don't know how the food handlers and drink, and bartenders and stuff would handle it. But you know there's a lot to think about. And if it would even make sense for them to open the room. Let's see the room maximum can hold 100 people, if they could only have like 25 people in there then financially it probably wouldn't even make sense for them to open.

MR: Okay. Well listen we've both had enough activity for today, let's both take the rest of the day off.

SM: All right. I need a break.

MR: Okay. Take care.

SM: All right you too Monk, thank you.

MR: Thank you.

SM: Bye-bye.